

A daily scan of national and South Yorkshire developments in education policy, inclusion, SEND, behaviour and accountability — weighted to primary and evidence sources, with links and a clear “so what for your school” line on the items that matter.

Useful? Forward it to a colleague. To join the circulation or partner with the network, [get in touch](#).

TOP LINE

- A quiet start to the week — nothing new broke over the weekend across DfE, SEND, Ofsted, safeguarding or funding beyond what Friday's weekly issue already covered (the NEU ballot pause, the West Sussex DSG deficit, the closed SEND consultations).
- The PE and sport premium digital expenditure return is due by 5pm this Wednesday, 30 September — flagged in Friday's issue, now just two days out.

→ **For your school:** Worth a quick check with whoever holds the PE premium budget that the return has actually gone in.

DATES FOR THE DIARY

30 Sep 2026 — 5pm deadline for schools' PE and sport premium digital expenditure reporting return.

22 Oct 2026 — NEU national executive reconvenes to decide whether and when to relaunch the paused strike ballot.

THIS WEEK AHEAD

- **PE and sport premium return closes Wednesday.** This term's digital expenditure reporting return for the 2025/26 PE and sport premium — shorter than previous years' forms — must be submitted by 5pm on Wednesday. It's a routine compliance deadline rather than a policy change, but an easy one to let slip in a busy week. ([GOV.UK \(DfE Update, 23 September 2026\)](#))

→ **For your school:** Confirm the return is in before Wednesday afternoon rather than after.

JARGON-BUSTER - REDUCED TIMETABLE

Coming up in Rotherham's still-unpublished Schools Forum papers, and a term worth having ready.

A 'reduced' or 'part-time' timetable is a temporary, formally agreed cut to a pupil's school hours — usually while additional SEND or behaviour support is arranged. It should never be used as an informal way to manage a difficult pupil out of full-time education, and DfE guidance expects it to be time-limited, reviewed regularly, and recorded with parental agreement.

MAPS IN PRACTICE - TOOL SPOTLIGHT: SCHOOL+

A strong inclusion strategy is only as good as the cohort picture beneath it.

School+ is the MAPs cohort-vulnerability framework — it maps who your at-risk pupils are and why, giving your inclusion strategy an evidence base rather than a wish list. [Explore School+](#)

SOURCES MONITORED

Weighted official- and evidence-first. X is monitored for early signals from official accounts and named commentators, and corroborated against a primary source before anything is included.

Source	Type	What we track
OFFICIAL & STATUTORY		
DfE / GOV.UK	Government	Policy, funding, statutory guidance and statistics

Source	Type	What we track
Ofsted	Government	Inspection framework, report cards, annual report
Explore Education Statistics	Government data	Exclusions, suspensions, attendance, census data
House of Commons Library	Parliament	Neutral briefings on bills and policy
RESEARCH & EVIDENCE		
Education Endowment Foundation	Research	Evidence-based guidance, incl. inclusive teaching
NFER	Research	Assessment, workforce, disadvantage
Education Policy Institute	Think tank	Policy analysis and the disadvantage gap
Institute for Fiscal Studies	Think tank	School funding and spending analysis
FFT Education Datalab	Data analysis	Data-driven analysis of attainment and exclusions
INCLUSION & PREVENTION SPECIALISTS		
The Difference	Charity	Whole-school inclusion; "Who's Losing Learning?"
IPPR	Think tank	Lost learning, exclusions, SEND reform
Youth Endowment Fund	Research	What works to prevent youth violence & exclusion
Centre for Social Justice	Think tank	Exclusion tracker and social-mobility policy
Whole School SEND	Network	SEND practice, resources and reviews
SECTOR PRESS & COMMENTARY		
Schools Week	Press	Breaking sector news and investigations
Tes	Press	Practice, policy and workforce
The Guardian (Education)	Press	National coverage and comment
X (monitored)	Social	DfE, Ofsted, EEF and named voices — corroborated before use
LOCAL & REGIONAL		
The Star (Sheffield)	Local press	Local schools and Ofsted outcomes
Sheffield City Council	Local government	Council decisions, funding and local strategy
South Yorkshire MCA & Careers Hub	Regional	Regional skills, careers and funding

Connect Daily is part of Sheffield Connect. Compiled by Andy Marsden, Sector Inclusion Lead.

For circulation across the network and partners. Figures reflect the latest published data at the date of this brief.